Dothan City Schools AI Guidelines: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *AI (Artificial Intelligence) Guidelines (Dothan City Schools, Alabama; created 04.24.2025, revised 03.31.2026)*. Page numbers match the document's own page numbering. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text.

3. Purpose (excerpt)

Source: page 2

This document ensures that AI use supports educational goals, protects student data privacy, complies with applicable laws (including FERPA and COPPA), and safeguards against inappropriate or unsafe AI use.

However, unregulated use may introduce risks including exposure to harmful content, bias, privacy violations, and misinformation.

The district will focus on:

- Data privacy, security, and quality

4. AI Strategy (excerpt)

Source: page 2

- Publish guidelines and approved tools list on the district website.
- Annually review approved AI tools for performance, compliance, and emerging risks.
- The District Technology Review Committee (TRC) will publish and maintain the Approved AI Tools List, review it annually, and archive prior versions for audit and transparency.

5. AI Governance

Source: page 3

The governance of all Artificial Intelligence (AI) platforms, tools, and services within the District shall be the responsibility of the District Technology Review Committee (TRC). This committee serves as the sole body authorized to review, evaluate, approve, and monitor AI technologies for use by students, staff, or on district-owned accounts, networks, and devices.

All AI systems—whether instructional, administrative, or operational—must undergo the district's established technology vetting process before deployment. Approval will be granted only if the AI system:

- Meets Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA), Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA), Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA), Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA), The Alabama Data Breach Notification Act of 2018, Alabama data-governance requirements, and district policy.
- Demonstrates appropriateness for K-12 educational use.
- Aligns with district instructional goals and security standards.

Approvals must be documented and reviewed annually. Vendors seeking to provide AI solutions to the district must supply clear evidence of compliance with these standards prior to consideration.

All AI platforms, tools, and services—instructional, administrative, or operational—must be vetted and approved by the District Technology Review Committee prior to any use by students or staff and prior to connection to district accounts, networks, or devices. The use of any AI platform not reviewed and approved by the District Technology Review Committee is strictly prohibited. Unauthorized use may result in access restrictions, reporting to administration, and disciplinary action in accordance with district policy.

The District Technology Review Committee will conduct periodic audits to ensure only approved AI platforms are in use and will provide regular updates to district leadership on emerging AI technologies and any recommended guideline changes. Approval is documented, time-limited, and reviewed annually for compliance, performance, and risk.

Vendors must provide model/system cards or equivalent documentation describing intended use, limitations, data flows, content safeguards for minors, and human-in-the-loop controls to support educator oversight.

6. Data Privacy and Security

Source: pages 3–4

The Dothan City School District is committed to complying with federal, state, and local laws, rules, and regulations, and other entities that provide standards for compliance to ensure data privacy and security are maintained for data used in AI systems. Compliance includes FERPA, COPPA (for students under 13), IDEA/Section 504 confidentiality, applicable Alabama data-governance requirements, and district policy. We will ensure that the Contractor’s AI systems comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws, rules, and regulations, and other entities that provide standards for compliance.

The Dothan City School District is dedicated to ensuring data to be used in the AI systems will meet the data quality standards established by our Data Governance Policy.

The Dothan City School District will conduct compliance audits that will be done by our Technology Department and/or the Data Governance Committee (DGC). The Technology Department and/or the Data Governance Committee will submit a copy of the audit to our leadership and the respective Contractor(s). We will also ensure that the Contractor(s) provide a Corrective Action Plan (CAP) based on the findings in the audit report that will include the steps the Contractor(s) plan to take to mitigate the findings, and the timeline by which they will be mitigated. Vendors must attest to reasonable administrative, technical, and physical safeguards aligned to recognized frameworks (e.g., NIST) and provide breach notification within 72 hours of discovery to the district’s designated contact.

The Dothan City School District will include in our procurement and contract document(s) verbiage (Appendix A), which the Contractor shall attest when submitting their proposals and any contract executed to perform the work. There shall be no use of district data for training new products without prior written DCS approval and documented scope. No AI vendor may access district data without an executed DCS Data Processing & Security Agreement and adherence to district data minimization and deletion schedules.

7. AI Procurement (excerpt)

Source: page 4

In the procurement process, the following will be considered: cost, data privacy, security, human-in-the-loop development, algorithm bias, model cards, system cards, interoperability, service-level agreements, key performance indicators, customizability, configurability, scalability, legal compliance, and contractor support.

The Dothan City School District will obtain a written statement from the contractor that:

- The AI model(s) have been pretrained, and no data is being used to train a model to be used in the development of a new product;

9. AI Competency Development (excerpt)

Source: page 5

The Dothan City School District will develop an education and training program that is focused on approved tools, data privacy for minors, disclosure of AI assistance, and how to identify/report unapproved AI use.

12. Use of AI Systems (excerpt)

Source: page 6

In alignment with Dothan City Schools' commitment to student safety, data privacy, and instructional quality, the use of AI systems by students, staff, and all other district users shall be limited to those platforms that:

- Are purpose-built for K-12 and minors, with age-appropriate safeguards and educator controls.
- Have successfully completed the District Technology Review Committee's vetting and approval process, including compliance with all applicable laws, district policies, and data privacy standards.
- Have completed and returned the DCS Data Processing & Security Agreement

13. AI Review and Approval Process (excerpt)

Source: pages 6–7

- The TRC will evaluate the proposed platform's privacy policy, data security practices, and compliance with applicable laws and district policies before approval.
- Approved tools will be added to the District Approved AI/Online Tools List, published and maintained annually.

Privacy and Compliance Review

- The TRC shall assess each proposed AI tool for compliance with FERPA, COPPA, CIPA, HIPAA, PPRA, the Alabama Data Breach Notification Act, and all applicable district data-governance standards.
- Any AI tool that does not meet district privacy or security requirements shall not be approved for use until deficiencies are remediated and verified.

- The Technology Department will assist with the implementation, integration, and technical configuration of approved AI systems, ensuring alignment with district networks, security protocols, and access controls.

Use of Unapproved AI Systems

- No AI platform, tool, or service may be used on district accounts, devices, or networks unless it has been reviewed and approved through the process above.

Appendix A: Data Usage Restriction Clause

Source: page 8

The Contractor hereby attests and agrees that it is expressly prohibited from using any data provided to it by the data providers—either in its raw form or after undergoing any form of processing, aggregation, or transformation—for the purpose of training a new AI System to be used in a new product, model, service, or offering (collectively referred to as the "Product") of the Contractor. The Contractor further attests and agrees that any violation of this clause will be considered a material breach of this RFP and/or Contract to be entered into by the Contractor, and may result in termination of the Contract, legal action, or both, at the sole discretion of the Dothan City School District.

Notwithstanding the restrictions set forth in Section 1(a) of this Contract, the Contractor may use the data provided by the data providers to:

- Customize the AI System currently in use, which may result in the development of a new AI System.
- Develop a new AI System.

The customization and development of the AI System is expressly required by the Dothan City School District to meet the specific needs of the School District (the "District-Specific Needs"). Any such use of the data for the district-specific needs shall be subject to prior written approval by the Dothan City School District and shall be carried out in accordance with all applicable laws, regulations, and the terms and conditions of this contract.

Appendix A: Request for Data Use and Model Training Completion

Source: page 9

Details of Data Use: The RFA shall include a comprehensive written explanation that outlines the following, but is not limited to:

- Purpose of data usage.
- Data elements that will be used for the AI System training.
- Duration of data usage.
- The manner the data providers’ data will be stored, processed, and secured.
- Name(s) of the individual(s) who will have access to the data.
- The controls in place to prevent unauthorized use.
- Specific types of data that will be used for model training.
- Risks associated with using the data for model training and how these risks will be mitigated.

Statement of Model Training Completion: The statement shall include a comprehensive written explanation that outlines the following, but is not limited to:

- Deletion of training data or training data will be returned by a certain date. If retention is required by law or contract, the vendor must segregate and protect retained data and provide a deletion certificate by the agreed date.
- A statement that no training data has been stored.

Pretrained AI System: The AI System used in the performance of this Procurement Solicitation and/or Contracts has been pretrained. No data provided under this Procurement Solicitation and/or Contracts are being used to train an AI System to be used in a new product of the Contractor or any of its partners or affiliates.